Payvorne: payroll software for small businesses

Payvorne sells payroll and payslip software to small businesses with 10 to 200 staff. Its outbound team of eight sales development reps wrote every first email by hand and spent most mornings reading websites. With Fernway, research time per company fell from 20 minutes to 4 minutes, and the team sent twice as many first emails in the same hours.

The sales leader said the biggest change was timing: reps started writing to companies the week they posted a new finance hire, not a month later.

Freightmoor: shipment tracking software for logistics companies

Freightmoor sells shipment tracking and freight booking software to logistics and trucking companies. Its account executives found that most logistics firms say little about themselves online. Fernway read their job boards instead, and companies hiring dispatchers or fleet managers became the first list each week.

In the first quarter with Fernway, Freightmoor's pipeline from outbound grew from 31 qualified opportunities to 54.

Clinivale: appointment software for clinics

Clinivale sells online booking and appointment reminder software to private clinics and dental practices. Its buyers are clinic owners and practice managers, who get many sales emails. Fernway drafts opened on something the clinic had announced, such as a new branch or longer opening hours.

Replies to first emails rose from 5 percent to 11 percent over two months, measured on the same number of emails.

Hirequill: recruiting software for growing companies

Hirequill sells an applicant tracking system to companies that hire more than 50 people a year. A company with many open roles is the best sign of need, so Fernway counted open roles on each prospect's job board and ranked the list by it.

Hirequill's four sales development reps stopped writing to companies with no open roles at all, which had been a third of their old list.

Shelfwick: stock and inventory software for retail chains

Shelfwick sells stock control and inventory software to retail chains with five or more shops. Fernway flagged chains that announced new store openings, since each new shop is a new stock problem. The team closed 9 of its first 20 deals with chains found this way.

Shelfwick also used the qualify and review lists to stop spending time on single-shop retailers, which rarely bought.